Current State Friction: High level overview

Call Reminder

Browse Front Shop

Place order

Receive Call

A dischem representative calls me to offer to prepare my repeat medication.

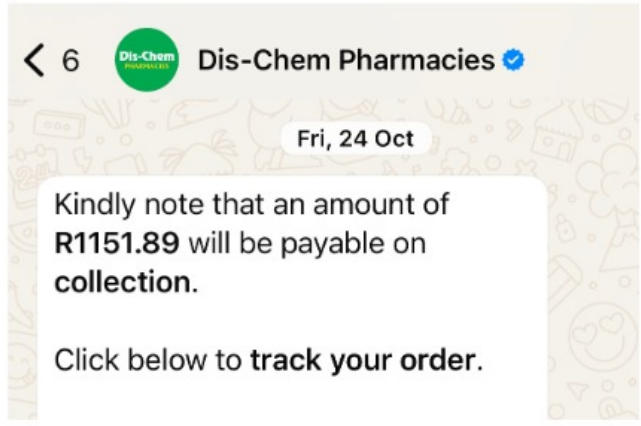
Place Order

I confirm that I would like them to do so, and that I would like to collect it at {name} store.

Receive instruction

I am provided with a date from when I can, and by when I should, collect my order.

I receive follow up communication confirming my order.



Dis-Chem Pharmacies

Fri, 24 Oct

Kindly note that an amount of **R1151.89** will be payable on **collection**.

Click below to **track your order**.

Any location

Access Channel

I stop at Dis-Chem on the way home.

Mall

I navigate the store to find the Dispensary.

PRE-ORDERED PRESCRIPTION COLLECTIONS ONLY

Dis-Chem Store

Collect Medication

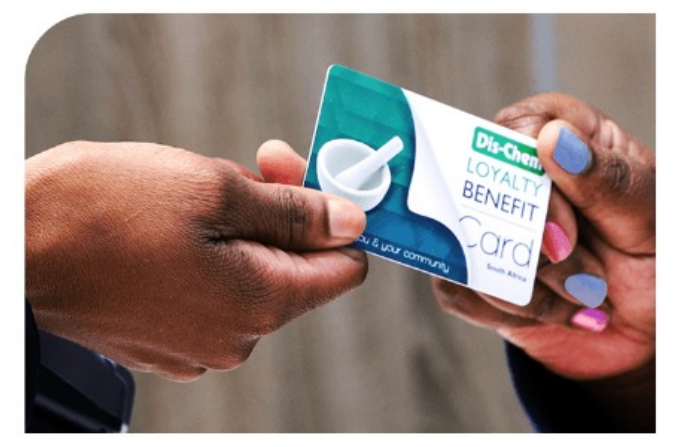
*

Queue

I find the right queue and wait until I am served.

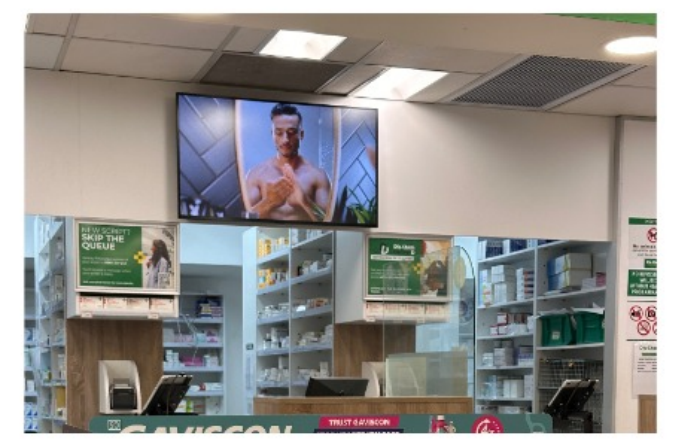
Identification

I state my purpose and provide identification.



Waiting

I wait to receive my package.



I wait whilst the pharmacist finalises my order

⇌

I receive instructions for usage of the medication

Receive Medication

Receive Order

I sign for my order

I and receive my medication and invoice.

Dis-Chem
PHARMACIES

Dis-Chem Dispensary

Purchase Medication

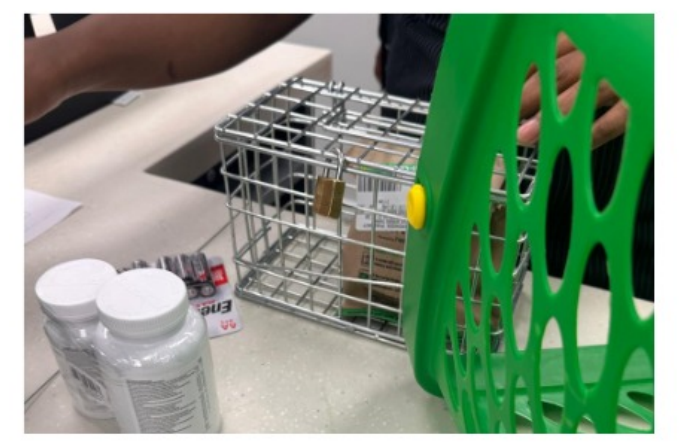
*

Queue

I navigate to, and join the checkout queue.

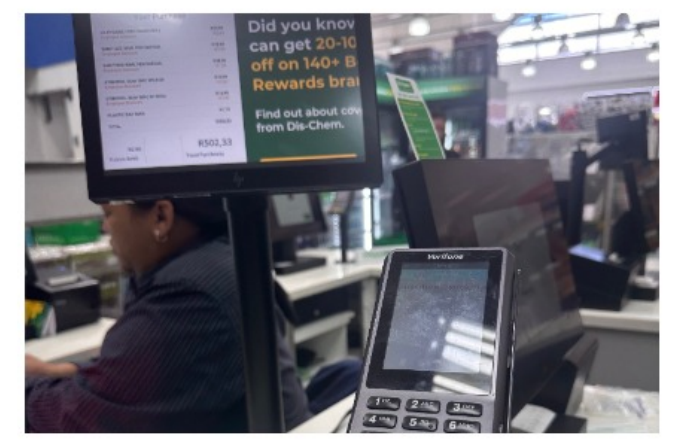
Check-out items

I provide my basket of goods, including my medication order, and loyalty card



Pay

I pay for my basket of goods with my card, including my medication order.



Dis-Chem Check-out

Phone Reminder Experience

Some customers report disliking the repeat-reminder phone calls. They often feel **bombarded with frequent calls**, which makes the service feel **pushy** rather than helpful. Agents may **not clearly identify themselves**, may jump straight into asking for **personal details**, or may be **difficult to hear** — all of which raises concerns about **scams**. Instead of feeling supported, customers end up feeling irritated, confused, or pressured.

Repeat Prescription Service Reliability

Customers don't trust Dis-Chem's repeat-prescription service to deliver correctly, or reliably. Many customers complain that even after signing up, their medication **doesn't arrive**, forcing them to scramble last minute to get their scripts filled. The reminders happen, but the **operational follow-through fails**, undermining confidence in the service. One customer noted feeling the **call centre and dispensary aren't in sync**. They receive calls after already submitting new scripts, or with i**ncorrect medication details**, which makes the service feel disorganised and even incompetent.

""after registering 2 months ago, … I have not had one delivery of my repeat script", and they ended up having to "rush [at] the last minute to get [the] script filled" in-store" ***Melissa (Hello Peter Review)***

Unreliable and Unclear Communication

Customers struggle with **unclear, unreliable, or mismatched communication** after placing an order. SMS or WhatsApp messages are often **not received, delayed, or misleading**, and stores frequently **don't know what the Adherence Centre has communicated** to patients. Customers arrive expecting medication to be ready - because they were told it would be - only to find it **not prepared, out of stock, or awaiting confirmation**.

""I submitted a script via WhatsApp as instructed and was told it would be ready the next day. I arrived to collect and was told it wasn't ready and that I must just stand in the normal queue. The staff initially told me I sent it to the wrong number, only to later find it on their system proving it had been received." ***Hello Peter Review***

Confusing and frustrating queue

Unclear **signage** and a **poorly defined layout** make the collections queue hard to find and distinguish, often causing it to **overlap** with other lines and attract customers who **aren't actually there to collect**. With the counter **unmanned**, people in the queue aren't sure how to get help or even whether they're in the right place. Instead of feeling seamless and quick, the collections experience becomes **confusing, slow, and frustrating**.

The **bell system** partly mitigates this frustration when noticed, reassuring customers that help is coming, but is not available in every store.

Inconsistent and Unreliable ID Process

Customers encounter inconsistent ID checks and frequent profile mismatches when collecting medication. Staff rely on different methods — some search only by surname (which is unreliable when many customers share the same surname), while others use the Dis-Chem card, app, or ID number. Address discrepancies across systems add further confusion. These repeated issues mean customers now *expect* friction at this stage.

Packages Not Ready When Customers Arrive

Customers often arrive expecting their parcel to be ready—because they sent their script in, received an SMS, or assumed the pharmacy would process it automatically. Instead, they're told the order hasn't been filled or captured, forcing them to wait, return later, or even rejoin the busy dispensary queue. This creates frustration, especially when customers believed they had already "done their part."

"Customers think when they receive the SMS their scripts are ready — they often don't read the SMS to say click on the link." ***Dispensary Manager***

Incorrect or Unwanted Items

Packages are sometimes incorrect, incomplete, or include items the customer didn't request. These errors require staff to fix the order on the spot—rewriting scripts, correcting repeats, or reversing items—slowing down the collections queue for everyone. Customers feel let down when what they collect doesn't match what they ordered.

"At collections customers are not always happy with the call centre… they process medication the client doesn't want. Then we have to reverse the script and correct it. It really takes time and the line become longer." ***Dispensary Manager***

Long Waits While Staff Search for Package

Even when orders *are* ready, customers frequently wait while staff hunt through storage to locate the parcel. Collecting for someone else or under a different surname slows the process even more. These delays make the "quick collection" experience feel slow, disorganised, and unpredictable.

Co-payments and medical-aid issues

Patients complain about unexpected levies, incorrect benefits, and funds being depleted without warning.

"med aid funds being depleted."
"Co-payments, to get a new repeat."
"Levy is to high/incorrect." ***Dispensary Managers***

Payment Process Adds Extra Waiting

After collecting medication, customers often have to **queue again to pay**, with queues that are most often longer than the dispensary queue. This makes the **final step of the visit feel like the slowest and most inefficient**, sometimes leading customers to browse further until queues shorten.

"..patients that are just getting a script sometimes get irritated because they have to re-queue to pay … why can't they just pay while dispensing is their question." ***Dispensary Manager***

Queues Move Quickly and Feel Efficient

Despite appearing long at first glance, **queues generally move quickly** once customers join them. Friendly and efficient cashiers contribute to a smooth experience, with many customers describing the process as "easy" and "quick."

Add After buying friction: after payment - but WHY was their a levy. Now need to piece stuff together myself